

Lala Guluzade

Overview

What is my professional aspiration?

Moving forward, on BA journey I want to:

- Focus on MBA admission and complete my applications for Round 2 in January
- Deepen my expertise in specific functional areas to position myself as go-to resource within the Firm
- Explore new industries/functions/geographies to gain valuable knowledge to broaden my knowledge base and continue building my network
- Continue my efforts in coaching and mentoring junior BAs and try to do it in a structured way (i.e., within project)
- Continue my efforts in Firm building through supporting recruiting process
- Establish new initiatives within the Office (currently working with other colleagues on ideas for health and well-being related initiatives)

As I Work Toward My Aspiration And Reflect On Previous Development Conversations, How Am I Developing The Relevant Skills And Growing?

Solves Problems

PASHA - OHI study:

- Analyzed results of 20+ Assets and identified areas of strength and development based on quantitative and qualitative inputs, identifying common themes across all
- Reviewed and corrected gaps in team analysis of results (e.g. correcting overstatement of score by 10 points for one of the assets, improved visuals and clarity of messages)
- Designed OHI Workshop agenda, detailed out activities (i.e., panel questions, facilitation approach) and created its visuals
- Developed comprehensive Culture Interview Guide with question and follow up examples covering all OHI dimensions, as well as examples of interviewing techniques
- Detailed out approach to initiative drafting incl., explanation of available frameworks and tools deployed by McKinsey

Ministry of Economy (MOE) - Tax-Based Economic Measure (TBEM) study:

- Contributed to development of LoP for Phase 2, outlining key activities, potential use cases and required technology stack for automation of the tool
- Identified synergies between proposed digital tool and tools deployed within Ministry to optimize implementation time and cost-efficiency

Manages Work/Projects

PASHA - OHI study:

- Regularly monitored project progress by creating detailed tracking excel, and providing regular updates to leadership and client teams, raising flags in timely manner
- In a study covering 20+ assets, organized different types of interactions (kick-off sessions, focus groups, CEO 1-1 and result playbacks) with each, ensuring adherence to project timeline
- Mobilized and onboarded experts to participate on OHI Workshop (needed to be done 2 times due to change in workshop date)

MOE - TBEM study:

- Continued on need basis with onboarding sessions with new client team, after project end, while supporting PASHA OHI study
- Continuously supported client on application of the developed tool and error resolution (for TBEM)

For both PASHA and MOE projects:

- Working in a setting without EM, owned the workstream as a standalone business analyst, mobilizing clients as needed and ensuring seamless communication between leadership, experts and client
- While staffed on PASHA, timely supported ad-hoc requests from Client, communicating to leadership capacity constraints

Communicates Effectively

PASHA - OHI study:

- Independently led:
 - 20+ focus groups with 10+ participants from different audience (management/non-management, white/blue collar) in 3 languages guiding discussion to identify root causes of observed problems
 - 20+ results playback sessions with CEOs and CHROs of assets communicating identified root causes during causes and providing solutions suggested by employees
 - 5+ 1-1 sessions with HR teams to go over results in more detail and support their correct interpretation

MOE - TBEM study:

- Became go-to person for advisor to the Minister, addressing both context and process-related questions
- Independently facilitated and led meetings with senior government officials, incl. advisors to the Minister, head of the Tax Authority, deputies of State Statistics Committee, and provided inputs at a meeting with the Minister of Economy
- Facilitated several meeting with representatives from various Ministry function, aligning all parties on required action for Phase 2
- Developed project impact summary documents in different formats (i.e., visual deck, vertical, excel table) for Minister presentation

For both PASHA and MOE projects:

- As key contact person with person, timely escalated to leadership any bottlenecks, as well as needs for external expertise

Builds Relationships**PASHA - OHI study:**

- Significantly strengthened relationship with key contact person creating more collaborative operating model (e.g. upon returning back to project received message that they would like to continue working with me)
- Supported on daily basis HR teams of assets, supporting resolution of content-related (e.g., explanation of results and etc.) and administrative questions (e.g. billing and contracting)

Builds Expertise

- Became go-to person locally for questions on understanding GDP, local statistics, OHI survey and people topics (supported CST's ongoing efforts)
- Co-developed pitch idea and joined Innovation Olympics contest based on learning from TBEM study, reaching semi-finals stage

Apprentices Others

- Held regular catch-up session with colleagues, who received Interim Check during last committee, sharing my personal learnings and tips and trick on how to act on their development needs
- Continued holding regular catch-ups with junior and newly joint colleagues, sharing my personal experience and addressing their questions

Who are my mentors/sponsors at the Firm?

Sinan K., Murat G., Ugur Cem Y., Rashad M., Maxim U., Simay E., Cem A., Mecit N., Gozde K., Nijat J., Yigit O., Ilbey K.

Looking Ahead**Apprentices Others**

I want to focus on coaching junior colleagues in a structured and start building this muscle, regardless of the path I am going to select (i.e., MBA or DtA). I would like to try myself in structuring and communicating task to others and balancing other team member's work styles with my own, since I mainly worked in small team set ups

Demonstrates Resilience

As I will be continuing my MBA journey, I need to ensure to be able to balance project needs and studying, also ensuring enough time to reenergize.

What support do I need from my mentors/sponsors and the Firm?

I would like support with getting staffed on a project with a larger team, so I can practice coaching junior colleagues in a more structured way. In addition, I would like to try myself in other industries and geographies, to experience working with diverse clients and work environments.

Will this plan give me energy and how can I make it sustainable for me, both personally and professionally?

Proactively scheduling 1-1s with my mentors and Firm Leadership to discussing my development plans and advice on MBA applications. I will continue dedicating necessary time for re-energizing and mental well-being

[Optional] Additional Considerations**What are the top 3 topics, if any, I would like to discuss with my DGL?**

Since I selected "DTA Cases with no certainty on MBA" in the last committee I am required to make decision by January. I would like to understand how my path may look like for both option choices (MBA and DtA)